SYNTHETIC SAMPLE PAPER - fictional, for pipeline testing only

Translating Algerian Arabic: mBART and Back-Translation for Dialect Translation

Abstract

We study dialect translation from Algerian Arabic to English using mBART and back-translation. We evaluate on the MADAR dataset with chrF.

1 Introduction

Dialects lack standard orthography and parallel data. Dialect translation is therefore harder than translation of standard languages.

2 Method

We fine-tune mBART on a small parallel corpus of Algerian Arabic. We then add back-translated data generated from monolingual dialect text.

3 Results

mBART reaches 38.5 chrF on MADAR for Algerian Arabic. Back-translation reaches 41.2 chrF on MADAR for Algerian Arabic.

4 Limitations

The parallel corpus is small, and we evaluate only with chrF.

5 Future Work

Future work will apply parameter-efficient methods such as LoRA to dialect translation.